

Open Source India 2013: A Celebration of the Power of FOSS



In the last issue, we took you on a pictorial tour of Open Source India 2013, Asia's largest convention on open source. In this edition, we encapsulate the essence of the event in words.

There was an unmistakable buzz in the air as a large number of FOSS lovers trooped in at the NIMHANS Centre, Bengaluru, to seek and share knowledge at Asia's largest convention on open source, Open Source India (OSI) 2013. The three-day event, which commenced on November 11, 2013, was high on action and information, and turned out to be a perfect platform for all those who wished to cash in on the true spirit of FOSS. Packed with interesting sessions, interactions and hands-on workshops, the convention saw the collaboration between the head honchos from the corporate world, tech buffs and FOSS evangelists, all of whom made the most of the three-day long affair. The jam-packed sessions and the charged atmosphere at the venue proved the growing acceptance of FOSS at the user level.

The convention witnessed the presence of over 50 speakers from the business world and the community. Major companies like The Attachmate Group, Oracle, Red Hat, Intel, Acquia, HP, Dell, MongoDB, EnterpriseDB, VMWare, Utech, CDAC, Liferay and Microsoft made their presence

felt at this 'open' platform.

Commenting on his fourth year of participation at Open Source India 2013, Mandar Naik, director, Platform Strategy, Microsoft, said, "It has always been exciting to be a part of OSI and this year was no exception. The technology sessions were highly informative with some of the experts sharing their insights on a range of topics including mobile application development, the kernel and the cloud. I feel the conference proved to be a great opportunity to engage with technology enthusiasts from all over the country, ranging from app developers and open source contributors to the students."

Day 1: Full of action!

The first day of the convention commenced with Sreehari Seetharamashastry, MD, Attachmate India Development Centre, delivering the keynote address. He spoke at length on 'Open Source - The Way Forward', discussing how FOSS has changed the 'technological outlook' in many sectors across the country and will continue to do so in the